

RUH Airport Status

DISRUPTED

As of 10:45 PM, Friday 9 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

163 flights cancelled today · last takeoff 10:40 PM · last landing 10:41 PM

Moving again: departures resumed 9:38 PM, first landing 9:45 PM; no official reason for the stop.

HEADLINE

RUH moving again after the 7:41 to 9:45 PM stop: 15 takeoffs and 11 landings in the last hour; 17 arrivals diverted today; 163 flights cancelled.

There were 15 takeoffs in the last hour, the latest XY265 to Cairo at 10:40 PM. The latest landing was GF169 from Bahrain at 10:41 PM, with 11 landings in the last hour. 163 flights are cancelled today (71 departures, 92 arrivals) and 17 arrivals have diverted. **Evening stop ended:** departures resumed at 9:38 PM (Jazeera Airways J9228 to Kuwait) and the first landing since 7:41 PM was flyadeal F3148 from Jeddah at 9:45 PM, so arrivals were stopped for 124 minutes. Since then the board shows 17 takeoffs and 11 landings, the latest landing Gulf Air GF169 from Bahrain at 10:41 PM. **Diversions:** 17 arrivals have diverted today, most during the evening stop: 8 to Madinah, 6 to Qassim, and one each to Jeddah (flynas XY46), Dammam (Saudia SV511) and ISL; earlier in the evening these included Saudia SV1040, SV1042, SV418, SV555, SV851, SV861 and SV264 and flynas XY42, XY206, XY366 and XY320. No official reason for the stop has been given by GACA, Riyadh Airports, the Ministry of Defense or SPA as of 10:35 PM. SPA and Al Ekhbariya carried condemnations of the attacks on King Khalid and Abha airports from Mauritania and the UN envoy for Yemen.

163

FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY

71 departures + 92 arrivals, 23% of 703 scheduled.

10:40 PM

LAST TAKEOFF

XY265 to Cairo, 5 min before 10:45 PM.

10:41 PM

LAST LANDING

GF169 from Bahrain, 4 min before 10:45 PM.

15

TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR

11 landings in the last hour.

17

ARRIVALS DIVERTED

Mostly to Madinah, Qassim, ISL.

Cancellation basis: Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 10:45 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 164 (71 departures, 20%; 93 arrivals, 26%) at 10:45 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today	71 (20%)	93 (26%)	164	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled today, board count	71	92	163	FR24 boards, local day
Delayed today	226 (65%)	165 (46%)	391	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	25 (10%)	49 (23%)	74	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	140 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Disruption index (0–5)	0.71	5	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	204 of 334	147 of 328	388 of 662	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	17	17	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	31	36	67	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	167	168	335	FR24 stats panel

CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	58
Qatar Airways	14
Turkish Airlines	11
flynas	9
Egyptair	8

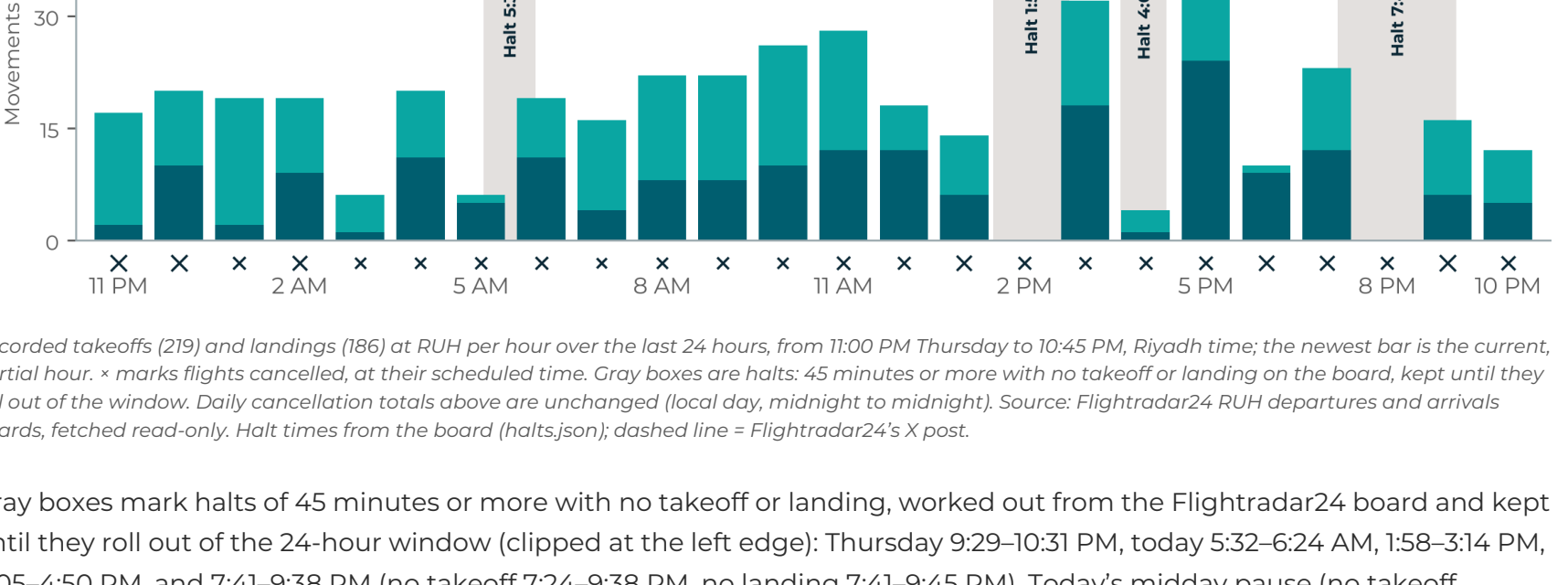
MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Istanbul	16
Dubai	14
Doha	14
Dammam	12
Cairo	9

Source: Flightradar24 public airport data (airport,json details/stats panel, fetched 10:45 PM; departures and arrivals boards, fetched 10:45 PM). Rankings count both directions from the board for today. The stats panel and the board count slightly differently, so a few flights' difference is expected. Outbound diversions are not shown on the RUH board.

AIRPORT FLOW, LAST 24 HOURS

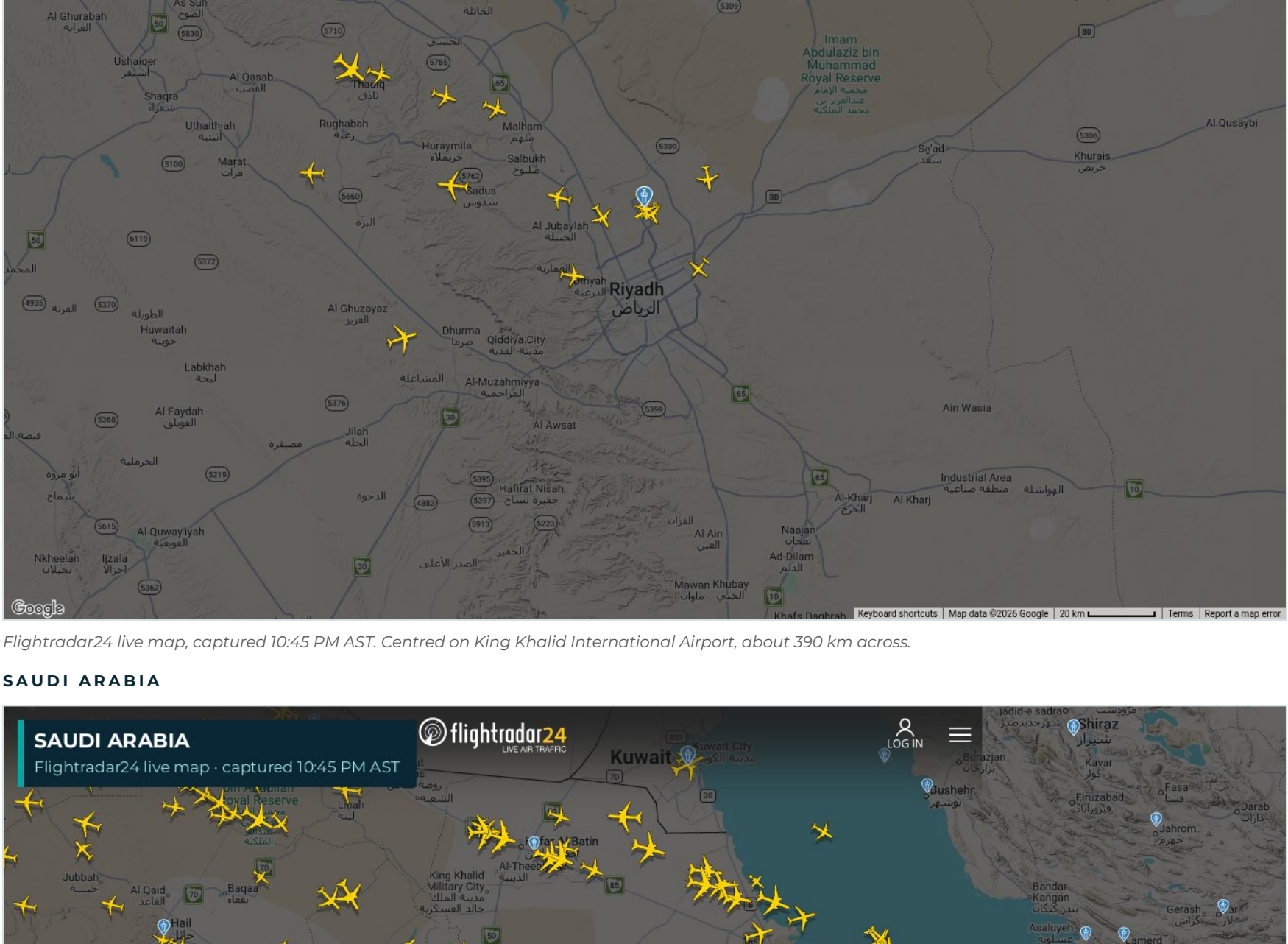
1 Takeoffs and landings per hour, last 24 hours to 10:45 PM.



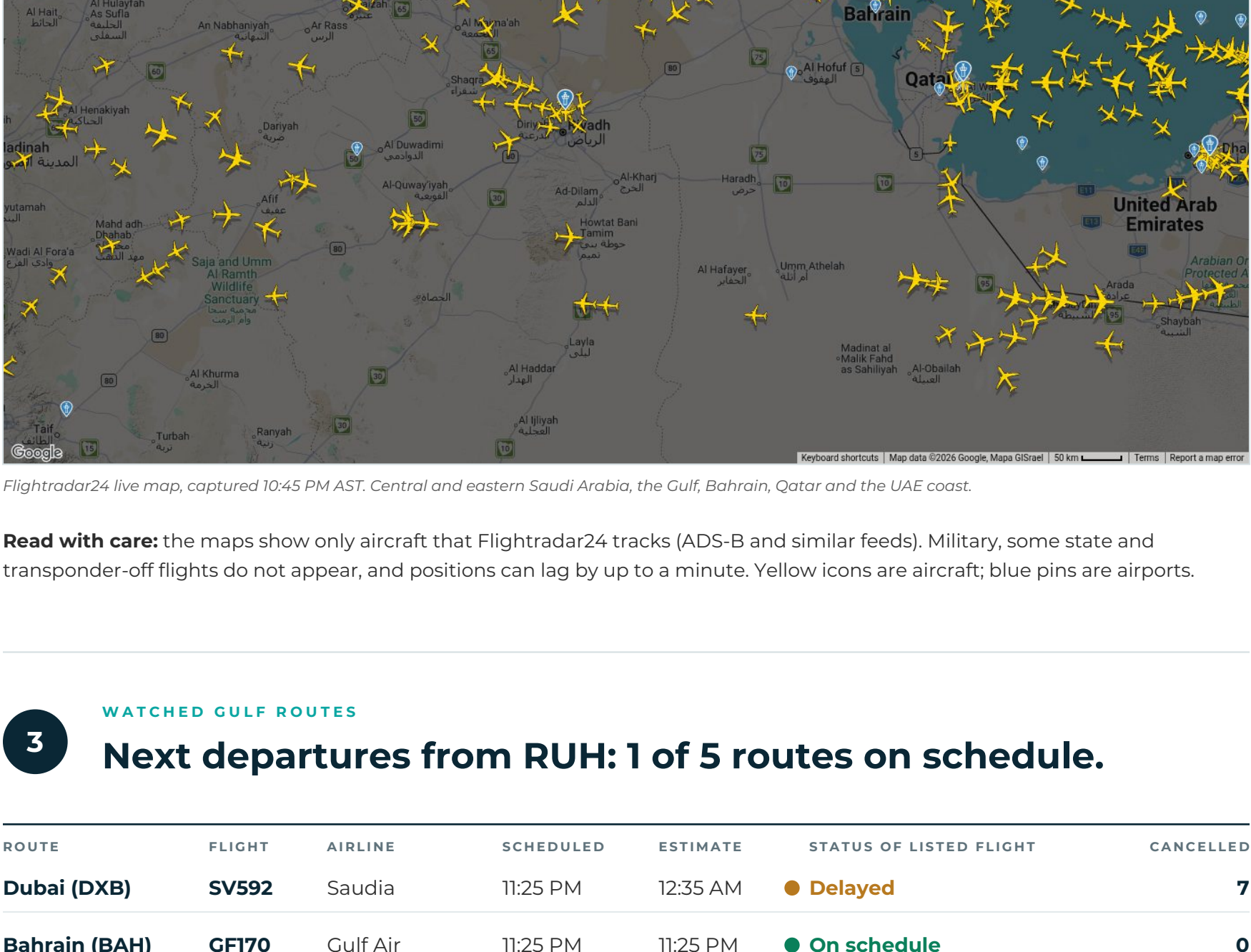
Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window (clipped at the left edge): Thursday 9:29–10:31 PM, today 5:32–6:24 AM, 1:58–3:14 PM, 4:05–4:50 PM, and 7:41–9:38 PM (no takeoff 7:24–9:38 PM, no landing 7:41–9:45 PM). Today's midday pause (no takeoff 12:29–1:21 PM, no landing 12:44–1:32 PM) was below the 45-minute mark, so it has no gray box.

AIRSPACE NOW

2 Live traffic picture over Riyadh and the region.



Flightradar24 live map, captured 10:45 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across.



Flightradar24 live map, captured 10:45 PM AST. Central and eastern Saudi Arabia, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast.

Read with care: the maps show only aircraft that Flightradar24 tracks (ADS-B and similar feeds). Military, some state and transponder-off flights do not appear, and positions can lag by up to a minute. Yellow icons are aircraft; blue pins are airports.

WATCHED GULF ROUTES

3 Next departures from RUH: 1 of 5 routes on schedule.

ROUTE	FLIGHT	AIRLINE	SCHEDULED	ESTIMATE	STATUS OF LISTED FLIGHT	CANCELLED
Dubai (DXB)	SV592	Saudia	11:25 PM	12:35 AM	Delayed	7
Bahrain (BAH)	GF170	Gulf Air	11:25 PM	11:25 PM	On schedule	0
Muscat (MCT)	WY682	Oman Air	9:50 PM	1:40 AM	Delayed	1
Abu Dhabi (AUH)	SV572	Saudia	Tmrw 11:15 AM	—	None until tomorrow 11:15 AM	3
Doha (DOH)	QR8731	Qatar Airways	Tmrw 11:45 AM	—	None until tomorrow 11:45 AM	7

Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures board, fetched 10:45 PM. Cancelled = today's cancelled departures on the route. Status describes the listed flight itself on schedule = no later estimate; delayed = estimate 15+ minutes after schedule. Dubai includes DXB only. Riyadh Air RX243 to Dubai, due 3:50 PM, finally left at 9:50 PM. Cancelled today include Emirates EK816, EK820, EK818, flydubai FZ848, FZ842, FZ856 and flynas XY217 to Dubai; Qatar Airways QR1167, QR1171, QR1241, QR1163, QR1165, QR1239 and QR1173 to Doha; Ethiad EY552, EY556 and EY560 to Abu Dhabi; SalamAir OY206 to Muscat.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

4 Traffic resumes after the 7:41 to 9:45 PM stop with no official reason; Mauritania and the UN envoy condemn the airport attacks.

Checked at 10:35 PM: Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED UN envoy for Yemen and Mauritania condemn the Houthi attacks on King Khalid and Abha airports
[SPA English on X](#) · 10:18 PM · published 10:18 PM; last checked 10:35 PM

SPA reports Mauritania condemned the attacks targeting King Khalid International Airport, the Houthi attacks on civilian sites in the Kingdom and expressed solidarity. At 10:12 PM Al Ekhbariya reported the UN special envoy for Yemen also condemned the attacks on both airports (<https://x.com/alekhbariyaNews/status/2108636663836803288>). Neither gives an operational reason for the evening halt.

CORROBORATED Flightradar24: many flights diverting to alternate airfields, then flights now making their way toward Riyadh
[Flightradar24 on X](#) · 9:31 PM · posts 8:50, 9:20 and 9:31 PM; last checked 9:33 PM

At 9:20 PM Flightradar24 posted that many flights were diverting to alternate airfields (<https://x.com/flightradar24/status/2108623703919763526>); at 9:31 PM it said flights are now making their way toward Riyadh. At 8:50 PM it noted the last landing was over an hour ago (<https://x.com/flightradar24/status/2108616180432814231>). The board matches: 9 diversions during the stop, no landing yet after 7:41 PM.

UNVERIFIED teleSUR says Houthi spokesman Saree claimed a ballistic missile attack on Riyadh airport; no matching Saree post found
[teleSUR English on X](#) · 9:00 PM · published 9:00 PM; last checked 9:11 PM

teleSUR English reports that Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree claimed a ballistic missile attack on King Khalid International Airport. We found no matching post on Saree's own account. The Ministry of Defense, SPA and Reuters had said nothing as of 9:11 PM.

CONFIRMED France and Syria condemn the Houthi attacks; Syria names King Khalid airport
[Al Ekhbariya on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 8:39 PM · published 8:39 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Saudi state TV Al Ekhbariya reports France condemned the Houthi attacks on civilian sites in the Kingdom and expressed solidarity. At 8:22 PM it reported Syria condemned the attacks on King Khalid International Airport (<https://x.com/alekhbariyaNews/status/2108609076263354737>). Neither gives operational information.

UNVERIFIED Posts call this Riyadh's fifth closure today
[Social accounts on X](#) · 8:36 PM · published 8:36 PM; last checked 9:33 PM

A user post says Riyadh closed for the fifth time today and aircraft are holding, with some depending low on fuel. Our board-based count shows this is the fourth halt of 45+ minutes today (5:32 AM, 1:58 PM, 4:05 PM, 7:41 PM).

UNVERIFIED Posts report explosions or sirens in Riyadh from 8:18 to 8:44 PM, and aircraft holding; no official confirmation
[Social accounts on X](#) · 8:31 PM · 8:18 to 8:44 PM; last checked 9:11 PM

Several social accounts reported explosions or sirens in Riyadh between about 8:18 and 8:44 PM, and air traffic holding near the city (e.g. <https://x.com/PeterVogel/status/21086093212096094356>). No official confirmation.

CLAIM Houthi spokesman claims Saudi jets carried out 77 air and missile strikes in Yemen in 24 hours
[Yahya Saree on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 8:26 PM · published 8:26 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree claimed Saudi warplanes carried out 77 air strikes and missile attacks on Sanaa and several provinces in the past 24 hours, using aircraft from Khamis Mushait and Taif. This is a Houthi claim, not independently confirmed; it says nothing about RUH.

CONFIRMED Civil Defense warns against filming or sharing interception or debris sites; no shelter order
[Saudi Civil Defense on X](#) · 8:11 PM · published 8:11 PM; last checked 9:11 PM

Saudi Civil Defense warned the public not to film or share interception or debris sites. It did not issue a shelter order.

SUPERSEDED Superseded: Traffic (via Al Arabiya) said three were killed in two attacks and operations had returned to normal; GACA stopped again at 7:41 PM
[Al Arabiya English on X](#) · 7:20 PM · published 7:20 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Al Arabiya English reports, citing the General Authority of Civil Aviation (GACA), that three people were killed in two attacks on Riyadh airport and that operations have returned to normal. BasNews English (8:10 PM, <https://x.com/EnglishBasNews/status/2108605958532268527>) also cites GACA for the three deaths and says one of the two attacks hit a Saudia aircraft; only Al Arabiya carries the 'back to normal' line. We have not found the GACA statement itself.

CONFIRMED Saudi UN envoy: the Houthis targeted Riyadh airport in a blatant terrorist attack and threaten civil aviation
[Arab News on X](#) · 6:59 PM · published 6:59 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

At the UN Security Council, Saudi Arabia's envoy Abdulaziz Alwasil said the Houthi militia targeted Riyadh airport in a blatant terrorist attack, that its attacks wounded civilians including women and children, and (per Al Ekhbariya) that it threatens civil aviation security.

CONFIRMED Al Ekhbariya: plans and preparations helped operations resume at King Khalid airport
[Al Ekhbariya on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 6:45 PM · published 6:45 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Saudi state TV Al Ekhbariya's correspondent said plans and preparations helped operations resume at King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh.

CONFIRMED The United States condemns Houthi attacks on civilian infrastructure and airports in Saudi Arabia; the UK also backs the Kingdom
[Al Ekhbariya on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 6:12 PM · published 6:12 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Saudi state TV Al Ekhbariya reports the United States condemned the Houthi attacks on civilian infrastructure and airports in the Kingdom and said it stands firmly with Saudi Arabia. At 6:09 PM it reported Britain also stands with the Kingdom and affirms its right to defend itself. Neither statement gives operational information.

CONFIRMED Riyadh Airports tells passengers to check flight status with their airline
[Riyadh Airports on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 6:05 PM · published 6:05 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Replying to a passenger, the official Riyadh Airports account asked travellers to contact their airline to confirm flight status and get updates. It gave no reason for this afternoon's stoppage.

CONFIRMED Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree says 'humanitarian flights' to and from Riyadh airport need a permit from Sanaa
[Yahya Saree on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 3:51 PM · published 3:51 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree posted that humanitarian flights to and from Riyadh airport will be allowed if they hold a permit from the humanitarian operations coordination centre in Sanaa. This confirms the statement was made, not that it has any effect on flights. The Houthis made no attack claim for Riyadh today.

CONFIRMED Flightradar24: Riyadh airport 'open again'
[Flightradar24 on X](#) · 3:18 PM · published 3:18 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Flightradar24 posted that Riyadh airport was open again, four minutes after the first departure following the halt (Fly Jinnah 9P581 at 3:14 PM on the board). The cause of the 1:58 to 3:14 PM halt is UNCONFIRMED: GACA, KKIASA and Saudia have made no statement. A precautionary closure is likely but not confirmed.

CONFIRMED Flightradar24: Riyadh airport 'closed again', no flights for an hour
[Flightradar24 on X](#) · 2:58 PM · published 2:58 PM; last checked 8:45 PM; widely re-shared since, still no official reason as of 3:31 PM

Flightradar24 posted that Riyadh airport was closed again, with no landings or takeoffs in the past hour, and put today's cancellations at 124, matching our board count. The cause is UNCONFIRMED: GACA, KKIASA and Saudia have made no statement. A precautionary closure is likely but not confirmed.

UNVERIFIED Social accounts report missile launches toward Riyadh and explosions around 2:05 PM; no official confirmation
[Interceptor News on X](#) · 2:09 PM · published 2:09 PM; last checked 8:45 PM; similar post 2:34 PM (<https://x.com/dana916/status/2108521397412679740>)

Several social accounts reported missile and drone launches from Yemen toward Riyadh at about 2:05 PM and explosions heard in the city, saying operations at King Khalid airport were suspended. GACA, Riyadh Airports and Saudia have not commented. The Flightradar24 board showed no movement from 1:58 to 3:14 PM (see section 1).

METHOD AND LIMITS

5 What the numbers are, and are not.

• Board figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, Gulf routes, chart) come from the Flightradar24 RUH boards fetched at 10:45 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or Riyadh Airports feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.

• The headline cancellation figure is the board count; Flightradar24's stats panel lags it by a few flights. Delayed, on-time, average-delay and index figures are the panel's own.

• Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
10:45 PM, Fri 9 Oct	10:45 PM	Flightradar24, Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA	Disrupted	Open sources - not official	12:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24 (boards, airport stats, X), Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA - Check your airline - Next update 12:00 AM